ELARA CIRCLES · DESIGN EXPLORATION · NOT IN THE APP

Three ways to sit in the same room

Every direction keeps one behaviour: a private room of up to ten women, Elara's weekly question, writing before reading, a shelf of past questions and a recap. Reply and “This resonated” come from the newer feed prototype, but they live inside the room and under one answer. There is no global feed, no counts, and no way to read before you write.

Same in all three

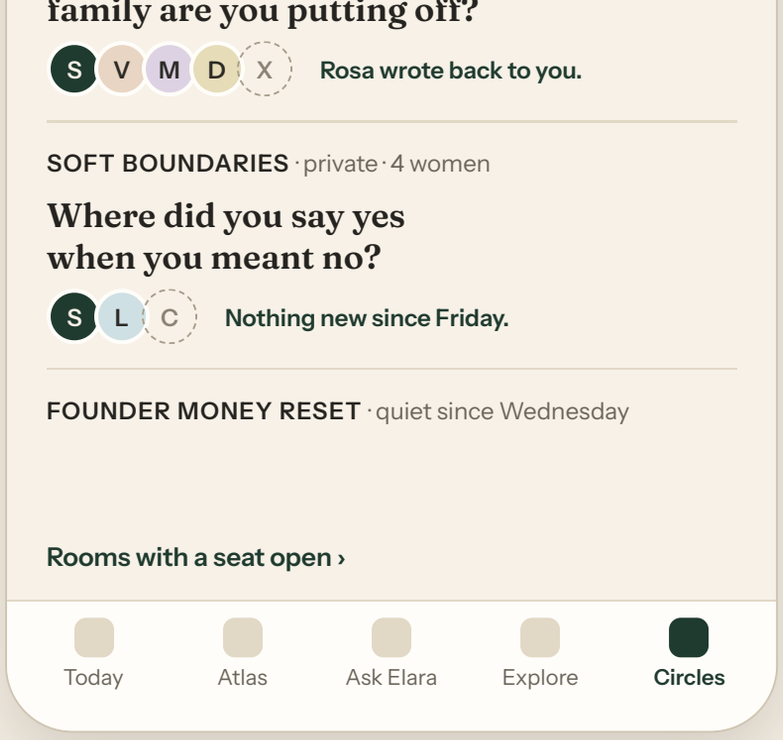
- **Room:** Mothers Circle, 8 women, seats for 10.
- **Question:** “What did you want a purchase to solve for you?” asked by Elara AI on Friday.
- **Order:** write, then read. Their answers open after yours.
- **Borrowed from the feed:** Reply under one answer, and “This resonated”, private to the author as names, never a number.
- **Shelf and recap:** 14 past questions; Elara's recap opens Monday.
- **Content:** the same four answers and the same two replies in each direction, so only the design changes.

1 Editorial paper

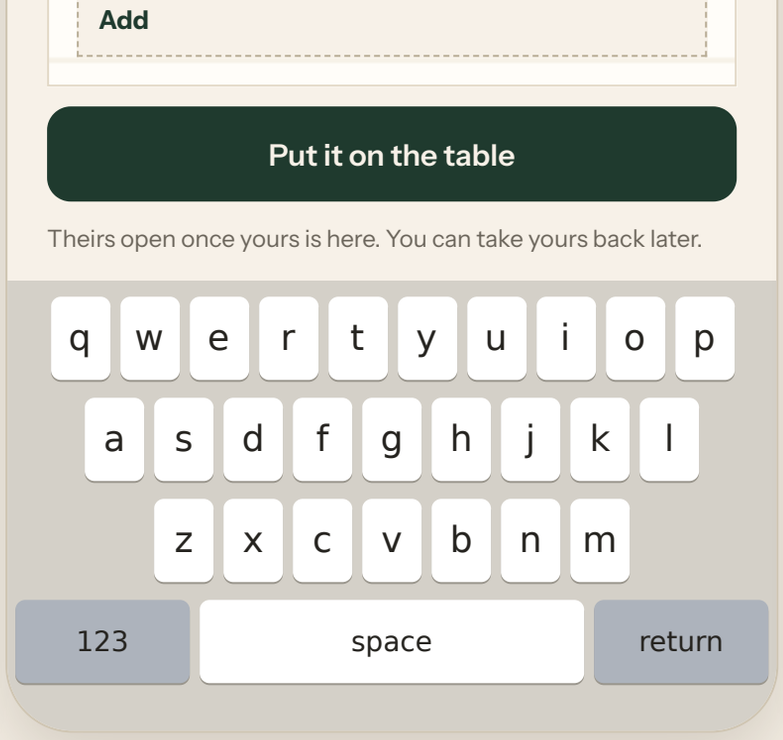
Refines what is already approved

The existing paper, seats and signature rule, tightened. A masthead and a hairline hierarchy make each room read like a page in a small publication: the question is the headline, the women are the byline, replies sit in the margin.

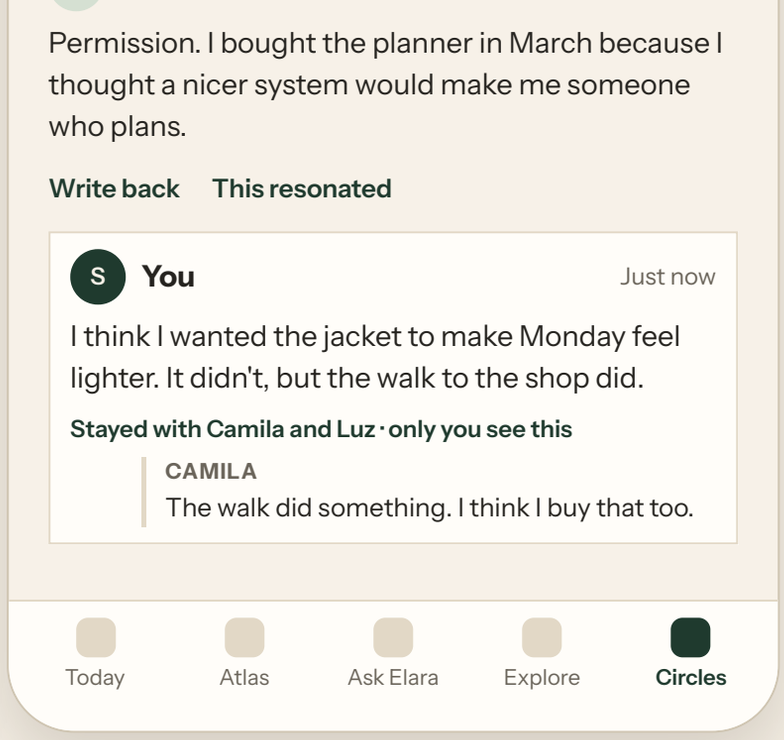
- Belonging comes from seats on the signature rule: filled for answered, dashed for waiting.
- Privacy is a quiet sentence under the question and a “private · 8 women” label on every entry.
- Least new work: closest to the shipped room, shelf and recap.



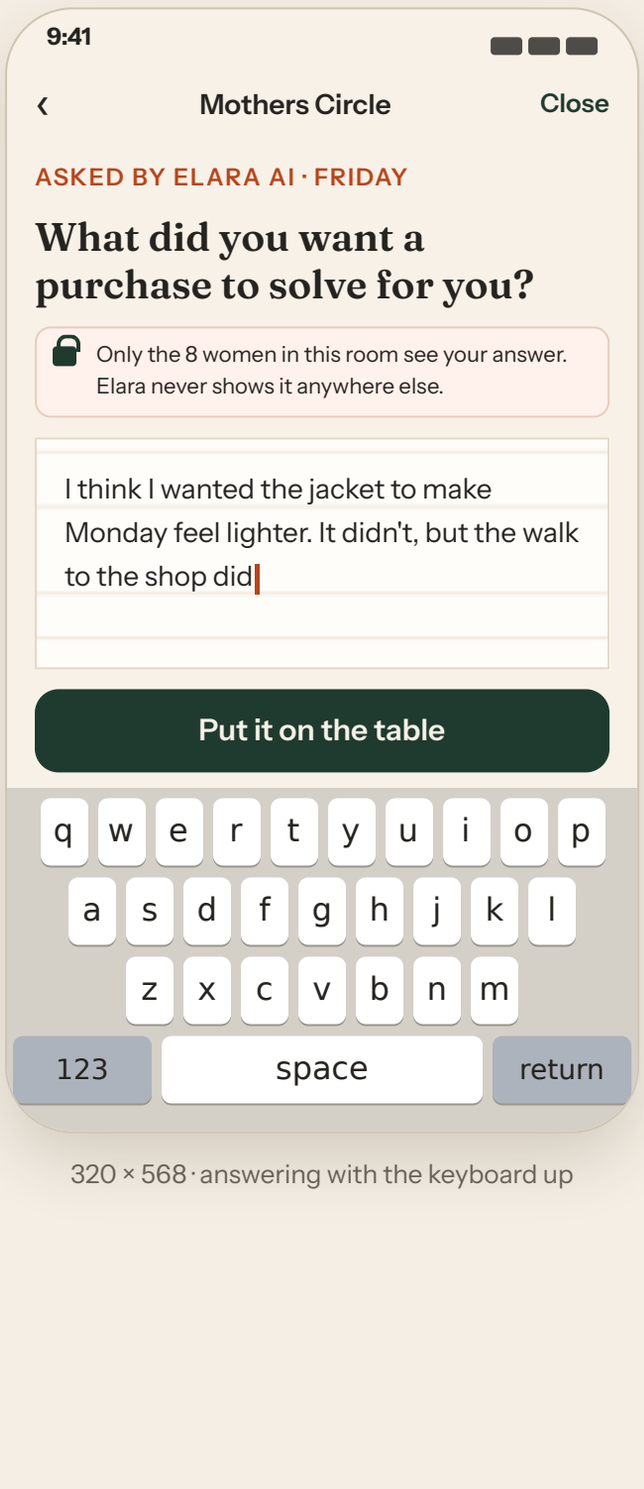
1 · Circles home



2 · Weekly question, answer entry



3 · The room after answers open



320 × 568 · answering with the keyboard up

Density test

Answer field measures 117px (about four ruled lines) with the keyboard up. The privacy box stays in full, at the cost of the practice line, which is dropped at this size. The button clears the keys. Hint text is hidden.

2 Tactile shared journal

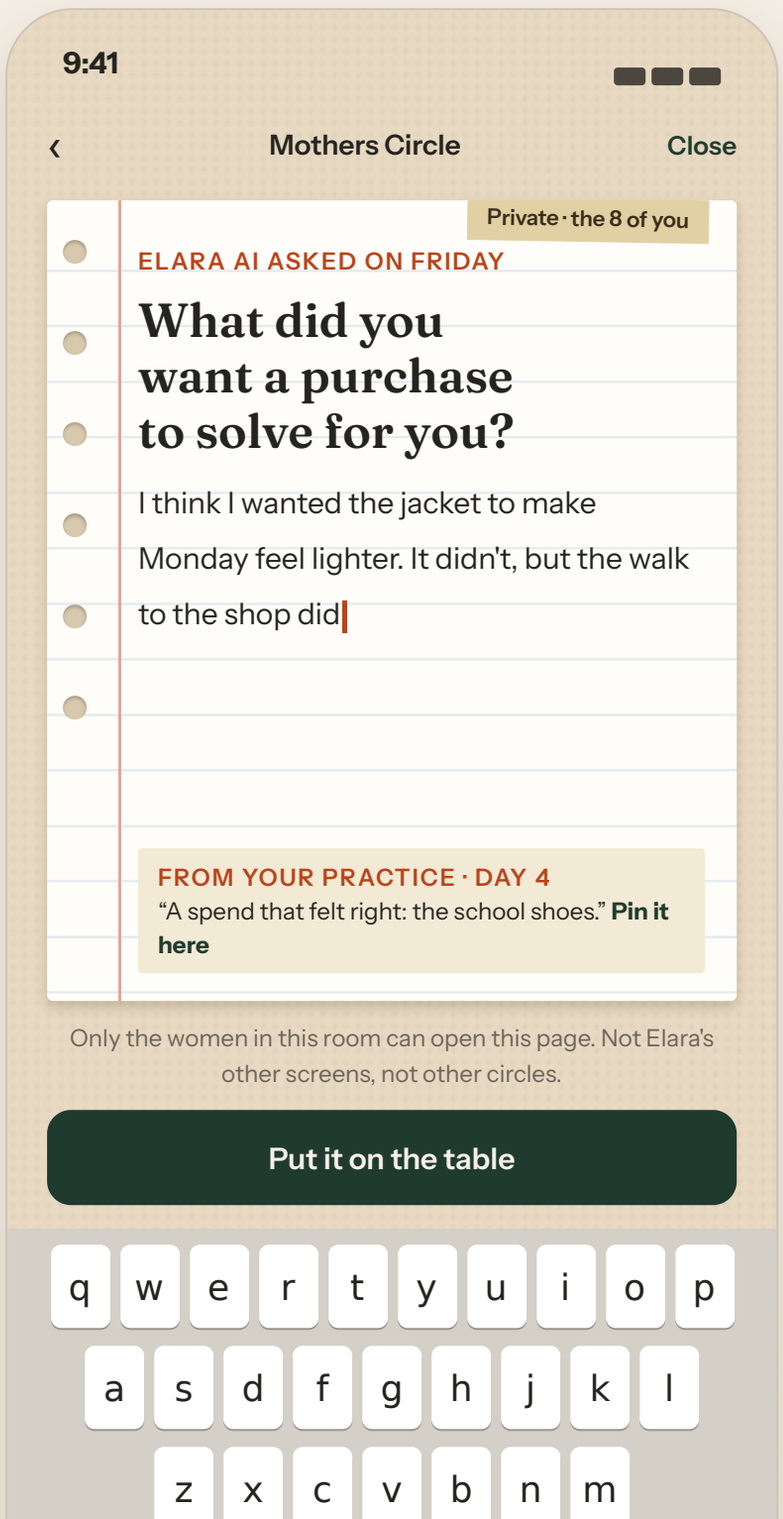
A notebook the women pass around

Each circle is a journal on a table. Answering means writing on a ruled page; after that, their pages are pinned on the board as notes with tape and small clipped replies. The leaf is the “This resonated” mark.

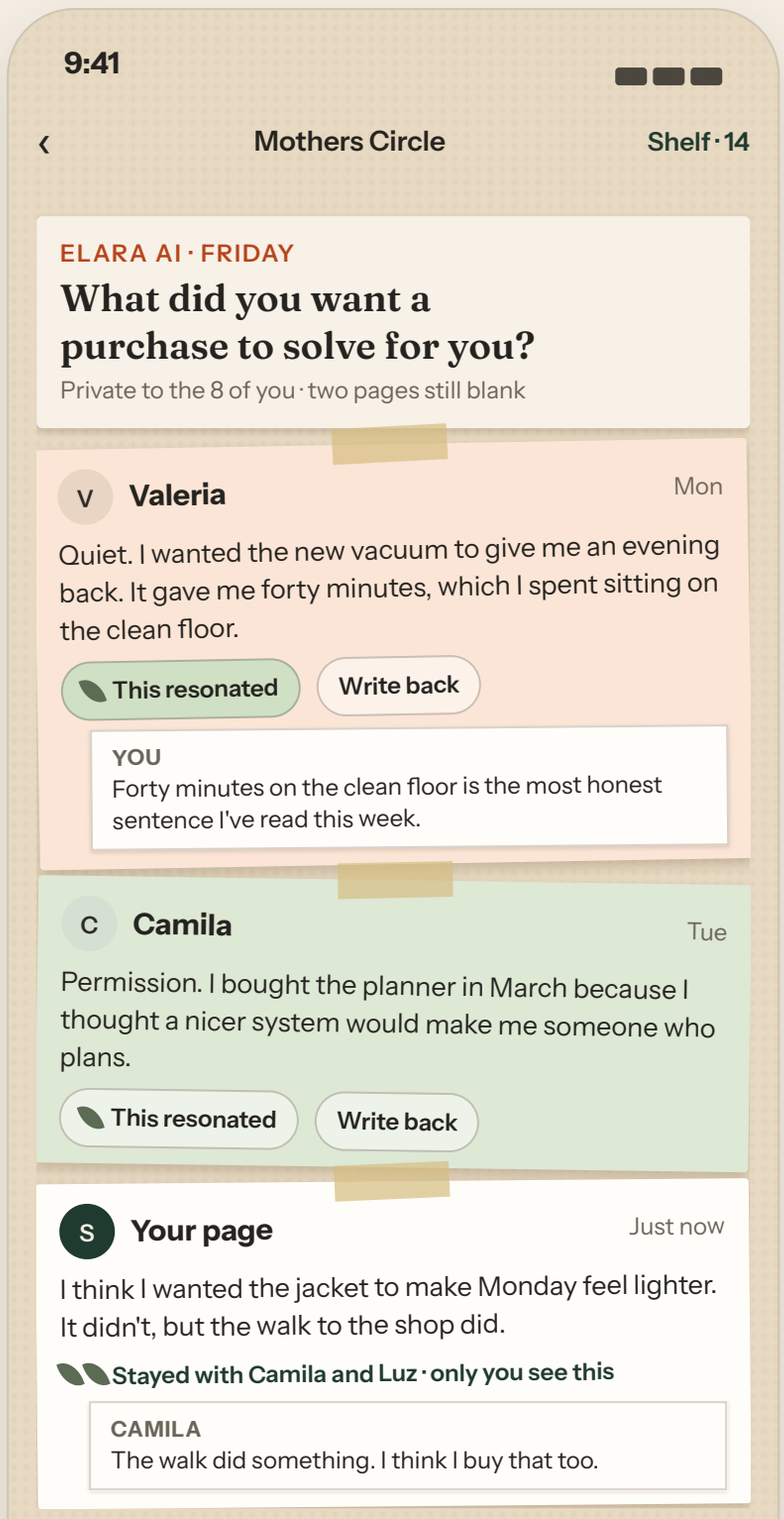
- Belonging is the strongest: it feels like a place with objects, and blank pages say who is missing.
- Privacy is told by the metaphor, but the sentence still has to be written out, and a tape label repeats “Private · the 8 of you”.
- Costs the most: textures, tilt and layered paper, with a longer reveal screen.



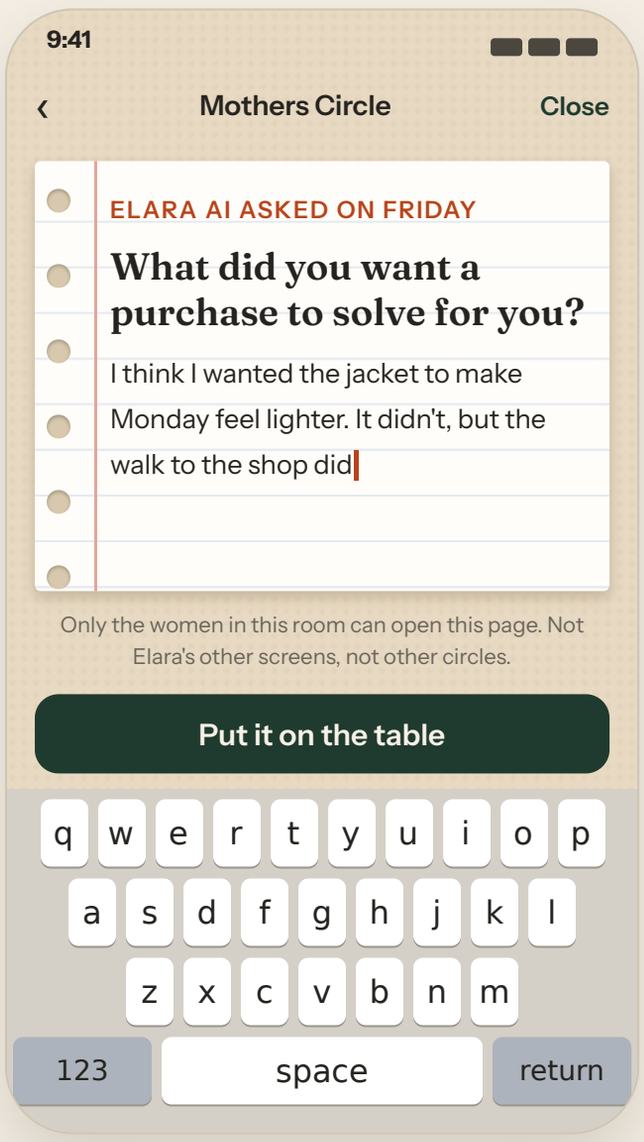
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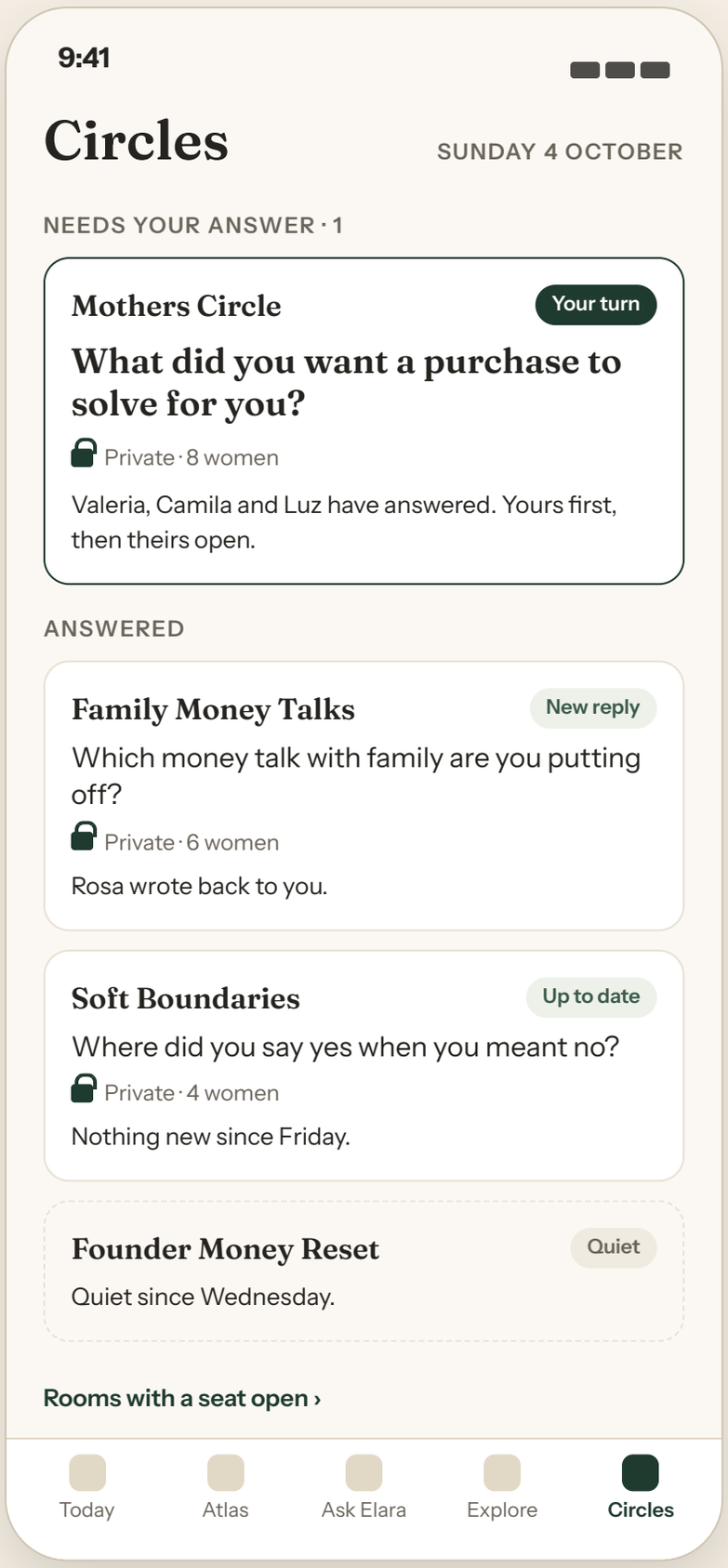
The page holds question and answer together and measures 217px, so it leaves the most room to write (about five lines). The cost is privacy: the tape label is dropped at this size and the audience is a two-line caption under the page, the quietest of the three.

3 Clear, scannable room

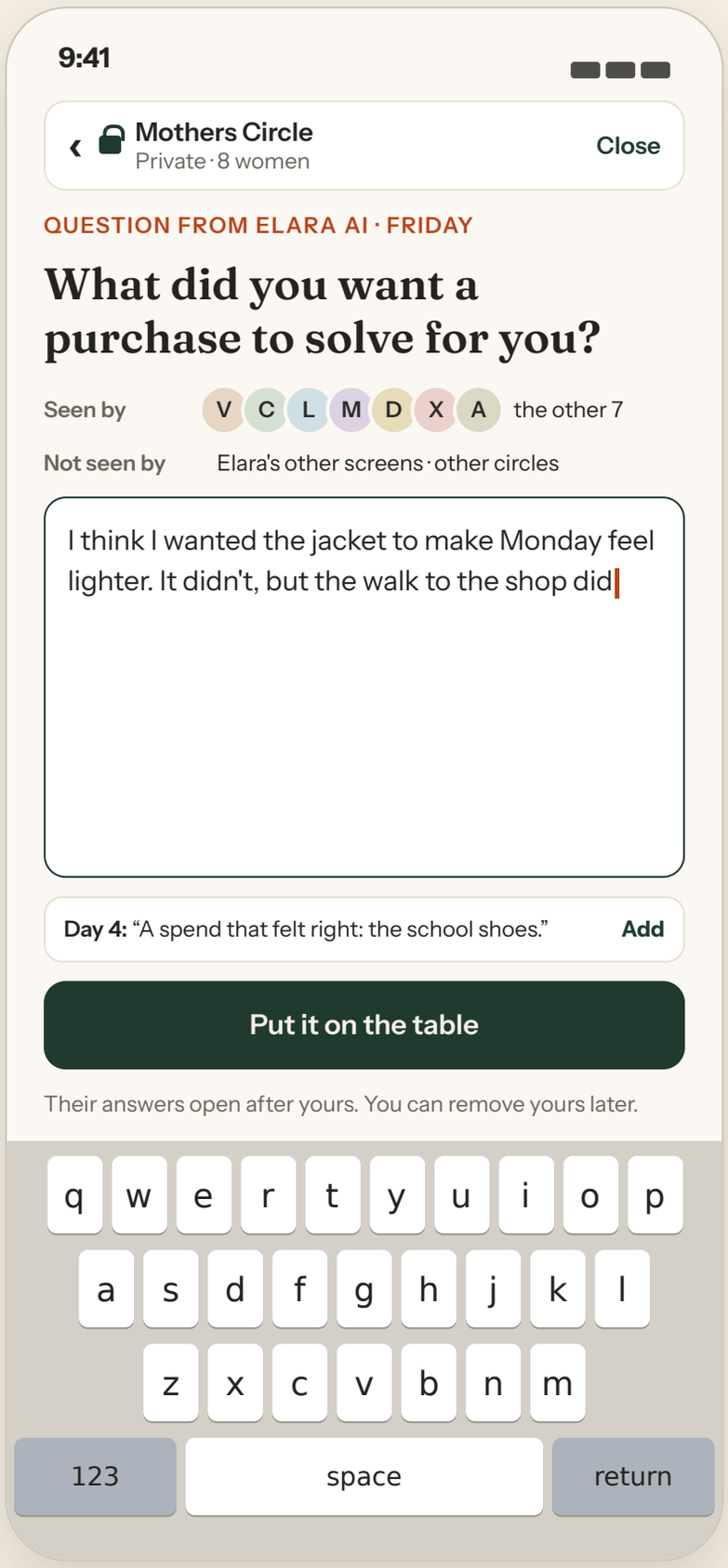
The easiest to read at a glance

A calmer, flatter room. Home sorts by what needs you; every room carries a lock bar with its audience; the reveal is a straight list with reply and resonate in a fixed place under each answer.

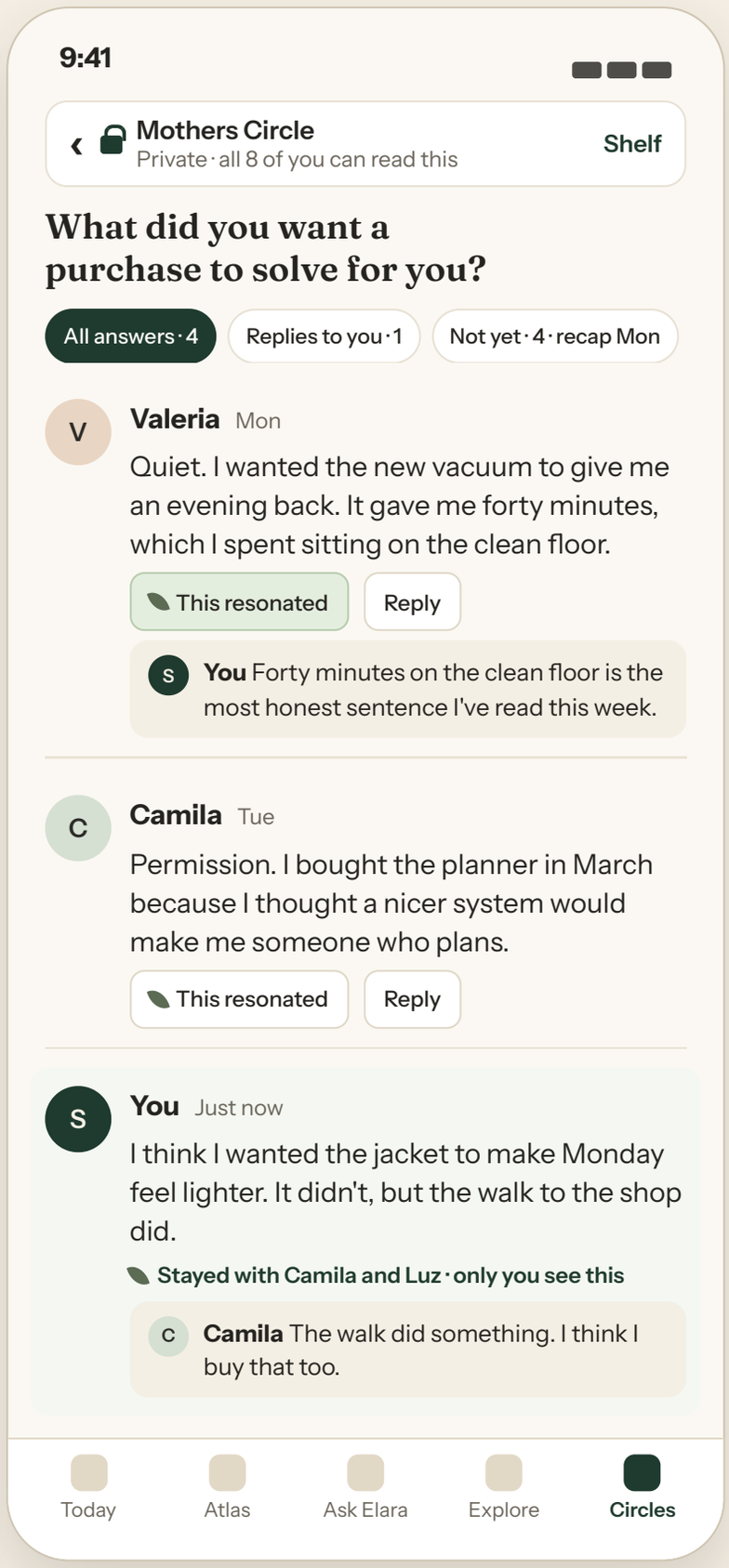
- Belonging is quieter: faces and names, but fewer objects. It reads closer to a tidy inbox than a table.
- Privacy is clearest: a persistent lock bar, plus “Seen by / Not seen by” right above the field.
- Risk: drifting toward a messaging app. The sections and the “Replies to you” filter must stay inside one room.



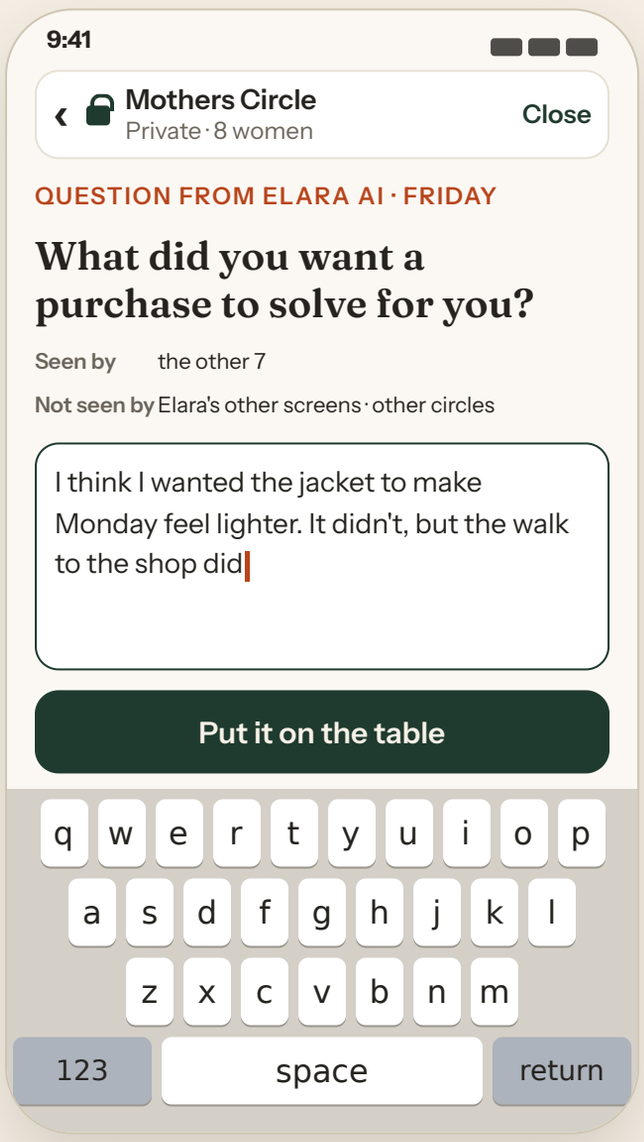
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Density test

Answer field is 115px, level with direction 1. The lock bar with “Private · 8 women” stays on top; the row of seven faces collapses to “the other 7” so “Not seen by” survives. Nothing important is cut, but there is no spare room.

Compared

Four things you asked about, scored from the screens above

	1 Editorial paper	2 Tactile journal	3 Clear room
Belonging	**Good.** Seats on the signature rule, names as bylines. Warm, a little formal.	**Strongest.** Pages, tape and blank pages for women who haven't written make the room feel inhabited.	**Moderate.** Faces and names are present but there is little to hold on to.
Privacy clarity	**Good.** One sentence under the question, “private · 8 women” on each entry.	**Mixed.** Metaphor says private, copy says it. Two places, both quieter than the other directions.	**Clearest.** Lock bar on every room screen, “Seen by / Not seen by” beside the field.
Readability	**Good.** Strong serif hierarchy; margin replies are easy to miss.	**Weakest.** Tilt, tints and texture lower contrast and slow scanning; long answers get cramped.	**Best.** Fixed positions for name, text, resonate and reply. Easy to scan eight answers.
Ease of answering	**Good.** One field, one button; the practice line is one tap on larger phones and drops at 320.	**Good, most room at 320.** The ruled page leaves the most space to write with the keyboard up, but privacy shrinks to a caption there.	**Good.** Same order every time: field, optional practice line, button. At 320 the field is level with direction 1 and the privacy rows survive.
Build cost	Low	High	Low to medium
Brand fit	Highest. It is the Elara you have approved.	High, but crosses into scrapbook.	Needs warmth added back through paper edges and seats.

★ Recommendation

Direction 1, with the privacy bar and the list order from direction 3

Build **editorial paper** as the base. It keeps the approved room, seats and paper, so it is the smallest change from what women have seen, and it makes “a room, not a feed” obvious from the first screen. The one thing the other two do better is privacy. Direction 3's lock bar and “Seen by / Not seen by” are clearer than a sentence under the question.

1. **Take from 3:** a lock bar with the room name and audience on the question and room screens, and “Needs your answer” first on home.
2. **Take from 2:** the blank, dashed seat for women who haven't answered; skip tilt and tape.
3. **Keep from 1:** the question as headline, seats on the signature rule, replies in the margin, and the shelf and recap rows.
4. **Fix in 1:** margin replies are easy to miss. Show “Camila wrote back” as a visible line under the answer.

Why not 2: it has the most belonging and writes best at 320 × 568, but it is the hardest to read, its privacy line is the quietest at 320, and it is the most work. Why not 3 alone: it answers every functional question but could feel like any other inbox. The next step, if you agree, is one combined direction at the same three screens and the 320 view. Nothing here changes the app; no app screens were replaced, and nothing has been committed or deployed.